US History · Unit 3 · Level 2 (modified)

Immigration & Cities



TODAY'S PLAN

- 👋 Push and pull factors
- 🏛️ Ellis Island
- 🏝️ Angel Island and the Chinese Exclusion Act
- 🏙️ Tenements and city life

Review · 5 minutes

Quick Review



🚂 The railroad (1869) brought settlers west. 🇨🇳 Chinese workers built much of it.

🏡 The Homestead Act gave free land.

🤔 Quick think: why did America need so many workers in the late 1800s?

Words to Know

Words to Know



Immigrant

A person who comes to live in a new country.



Push factor

A problem that pushes people to leave, like war, hunger or no jobs.



Pull factor

Something that pulls people to a new place, like jobs, land or freedom.



Ellis Island

The station in New York Harbor where most European immigrants were checked (1892-1954).

Words to Know

More Words to Know



🏝️ **Angel Island**: The station in San Francisco Bay where many Chinese immigrants were held, sometimes for months.

🚫 **Chinese Exclusion Act**: A law (1882) that stopped most Chinese workers from coming to the US.

🏚️ **Tenement**: A crowded, unsafe city apartment building where many poor immigrant families lived.

🗽 **Statue of Liberty**: A statue (1886) in New York Harbor. A poem on it welcomes “your tired, your poor.”

Learn

A Nation of Immigrants



From 1880 to 1920 about **20 million** immigrants came to the US.

Most came from Europe. Others came from China, Japan, Mexico and more.

Factories, mines and railroads needed workers.

Compare

Push and Pull Factors



👋 Push (leave home)

war or unsafe government
hunger and poverty
no jobs or land
unfair treatment for religion

🧲 Pull (come to the US)

factory and railroad jobs
cheap or free land
freedom of religion and speech
family already here

🃏 Check 1 of 4



A family leaves because there is no food. This is a...

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Pull factor

2️⃣ Push factor

3️⃣ Melting pot



Push factor

Problems at home push people to leave.

Learn

The Statue of Liberty (1886)

The statue was a gift from **France**.

Emma Lazarus's poem “The New Colossus” is on it:

“Give me your tired, your poor, your huddled masses yearning to breathe free.”



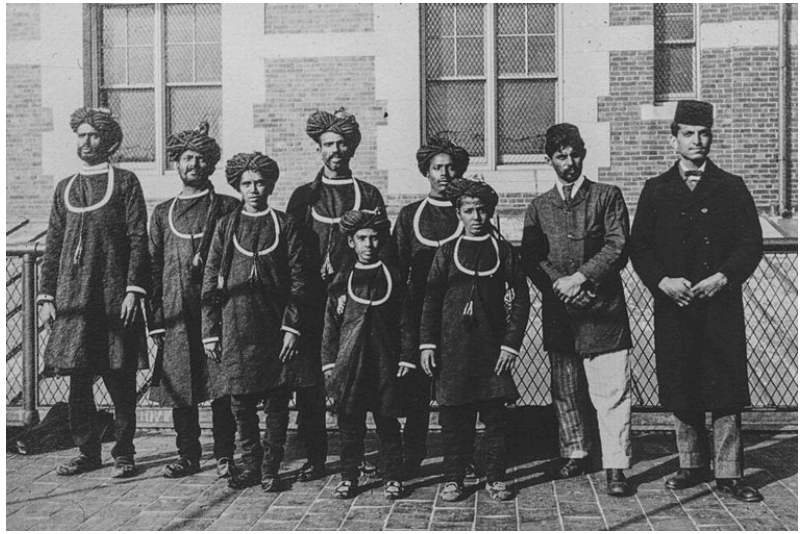
Learn

Ellis Island, New York

From 1892 to 1924 about **3 out of 4** immigrants came through Ellis Island.

Doctors gave a quick medical exam and checked eyes for **trachoma**.

Only about **2%** were sent back.



🃏 Check 2 of 4



What happened at Ellis Island?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Immigrants got free land

2️⃣ Immigrants built ships

3️⃣ Immigrants had medical and legal checks



Immigrants had medical and legal checks

Doctors and inspectors checked each person.

Learn

Angel Island, California

Angel Island (San Francisco Bay) opened in 1910.

Many **Chinese** immigrants were held there for **weeks or months** and questioned.

Some carved poems into the walls. You can still read them.



Learn

The Chinese Exclusion Act (1882)



The first US law to ban one **ethnic group** from coming.

It stopped most Chinese workers from immigrating.

Cartoons of the time drew Chinese people in mean, unfair ways.

🃏 Check 3 of 4



Why were Chinese immigrants held at Angel Island?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ The Chinese Exclusion Act made it hard to get in

2️⃣ They wanted to stay there

3️⃣ There was no room in New York

✅ Answer · Card 3 of 4



The Chinese Exclusion Act made it hard to get in

The law made officials question and hold them.

Learn

Life in the City



Many immigrants lived in **tenements** on New York's Lower East Side.

Rooms were dark, crowded and unsafe, with little fresh air.

Jacob Riis's photo book “How the Other Half Lives” (1890) showed the problem and led to new housing laws.

🃏 Check 4 of 4



What did Jacob Riis do?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Built the Statue of Liberty

2️⃣ Wrote the Chinese Exclusion Act

3️⃣ Took photos of tenements to push for change



Took photos of tenements to push for change

His photos shocked readers into action.

🎬 Video

Voices of Angel Island: Fong See

Scan to watch

👀 Watch for: why he came and what was hard

💬 Captions on

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5bxphvFYA7k

Wrap-Up

Recap



Push
reasons to leave



Pull
reasons to come



Ellis Island
New York, mostly Europeans



Angel Island
California, many Chinese

Wrap-Up

Exit Ticket



Give 1 push and 1 pull factor.

Compare Ellis Island and Angel Island.

Why did Jacob Riis take photos?